09-26 第2篇

阅读理解（记叙文） The 800-Metre Race I Didn't Want to Run

① In the middle of October last year, our school held its autumn Sports Meet. My name appeared on the class list for the **800-metre race**. I stared at the paper on the notice board for almost a minute. I am small for my age, I get tired after one lap around the playground, and I had never — not once — run 800 metres in my life. When I asked our class monitor why my name was there, she only said, "We drew lots. Sorry, Nan Nan. There weren't enough runners for Grade 8 girls." She patted my shoulder and walked away.

② I tried, for two days, to find a way out. I told my mother I had a sore knee; she looked at me, gently, and said, "Nan Nan, we both know your knees are fine." I told my head teacher Mr. Lu I might have a stomach problem; he smiled the small tired smile of a man who had heard all these excuses before and said, "Bring me a doctor's note if it's real. Otherwise, see you at the starting line." On the day before the race, I came home, closed my bedroom door, and cried a little. I was not afraid of pain. I was afraid of **being watched while I failed**.

③ That evening, my grandfather came for dinner. He is seventy-one, with thin grey hair and hands that shake slightly when he pours soup. I did not plan to tell him. But at dinner he noticed my quiet face, and somehow the whole thing came out. My grandfather did not laugh. He did not give me a speech either. He only said, "Tomorrow, when you run, pretend I am at the last hundred metres. Just reach me. That's all." Then he ate his soup.

④ On the morning of the race, the playground was loud with drums, class flags and shouting. Six runners stood at the starting line of the 800-metre race for Grade 8 girls. Beside me was **Qian Yue**, the strongest runner in our grade — a tall, fast girl who had won the 400 m three years in a row. When the starting gun fired, everyone shot forward like small arrows. I took three strides and already knew, with a sinking feeling, that I could not keep their speed. By the end of the first lap, I was **the last**. By the start of the second lap, the gap had grown so wide that the noisy crowd seemed far away, and I could hear my own breath louder than the drums.

⑤ My legs burned. My mouth was dry. Halfway through the second lap, my right foot stumbled on a small stone, and for a second I thought I would fall and give up. Then, out of the crowd somewhere near the 700-metre mark, I heard a short, clear voice — not a shout, just a firm old voice: "**Nan Nan, I'm here!**" I looked up. On the grass edge, holding a small class flag of my school, stood my **grandfather**. I had not invited him. I did not even know he knew the way.

⑥ At that moment something small but firm changed inside me. I stopped thinking about the crowd. I stopped thinking about the other five girls ahead. I only ran towards him. I did not get faster — my legs were already doing all they could. But I kept running, lap after lap, without slowing down, all the way to the finish line. I came in last, by almost thirty seconds. I did not win any medal. The scoreboard wrote my time in a plain, clear number: **4 minutes 12 seconds**.

⑦ After the race I was very tired and a little dizzy. I sat on the grass, and my grandfather walked over slowly, holding a small bottle of water and the tiny school flag. He did not say "well done" in a big voice. He only said, "You were last. But you finished. That is not nothing." Then he quietly added: "Many people never start the things they are afraid of. Today you did. Remember how this feels." I did not cry. But I looked at the number on the scoreboard for a long time — **4:12, Nan Nan, Class 7** — and I understood that it was not a bad number. It was **mine**.

⑧ This year, I am in Grade 9. My name is once again on the 800-metre list, but this time I did not try to get out of it. In fact, since March, I have run six mornings a week, four laps each time, before class. My new best time is **3:38**. I will still not win any medal — Qian Yue and her friends will cross the line long before me. But when I stand at the starting line on the morning of 18th October this year, I know exactly what I will do: I will **find my grandfather in the crowd**, breathe once, and run. **Some races are not about coming first. They are about refusing to stay on the side.**

注释： notice board 公告栏；drew lots 抽签；stumble 绊倒；scoreboard 计分板；medal 奖牌

根据文章内容，选择最佳答案。

1. Why did the writer's name appear on the 800-metre race list (Paragraph 1)?

A. Because she was the strongest runner in the class.
B. Because she volunteered happily.
C. Because the class drew lots, and there were not enough runners for Grade-8 girls.
D. Because the teacher disliked her.

2. What did Mr. Lu, the head teacher, tell the writer when she tried to say she might have a stomach problem (Paragraph 2)?

A. He immediately let her off the race.
B. He said, "Bring me a doctor's note if it's real. Otherwise, see you at the starting line."
C. He gave her medicine.
D. He asked the class to vote.

3. What advice did the writer's grandfather give her at dinner the night before the race (Paragraph 3)?

A. He told her to pretend he would be at the last hundred metres of the track; she should just "reach" him.
B. He told her to run as fast as she could and win a gold medal.
C. He told her to cheat by taking a shortcut.
D. He told her to stay home.

4. What did the writer hear near the 700-metre mark during the race (Paragraph 5)?

A. Her grandfather's firm old voice calling, "Nan Nan, I'm here!"; he was standing on the grass edge holding a small class flag.
B. A loud announcement that the race was cancelled.
C. Qian Yue laughing at her.
D. A bell telling her to stop.

5. Which sentence best states the main idea of the whole story?

A. Winning a medal is the only thing that matters in a race.
B. Some races are not about coming first; they are about refusing to stay on the side, about finishing what we are afraid of.
C. Students who cannot run fast should never take part in any race.
D. Grandparents should keep their opinions to themselves.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第①段 "drew lots ... there weren't enough runners for Grade 8 girls"
【解析】因抽签且人手不够而被选中。A、B、D 均错。故选 C。

2.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段 "Bring me a doctor's note if it's real. Otherwise, see you at the starting line"
【解析】班主任要求提供医生证明否则必跑。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

3.
【答案】A
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第③段 "Tomorrow, when you run, pretend I am at the last hundred metres. Just reach me"
【解析】爷爷让她想象他在终点附近。B、C、D 均错。故选 A。

4.

【答案】A

【题型】细节理解题

【定位】第⑤段 "firm old voice: 'Nan Nan, I'm here!' ... stood my grandfather ... holding a small class flag"

【解析】爷爷在赛场边呼喊并举旗。B、C、D 均错。故选 A。

5.

【答案】B

【题型】主旨/观点题

【定位】第⑦⑧段 "refusing to stay on the side ... Some races are not about coming first"

【解析】全文主旨：不必第一，拒做旁观者即胜利。A、C、D 均偏离。故选 B。